

Purchasing A Music CD

We gave Ram Mohan Rao a chance to get a favourite CD of his, on the house. Unfortunately, he was not allowed to get two different CDs—he had to get the same CD twice, one the Old Way, and one the Tech Way. Here's what happened when Ram went about buying them.

Ram Mohan Rao (ram_mohan@thinkdigit.com)



I found and bought the CD immediately



Amazon has a great collection, but shipping...

1

I already have a copy of Beethoven's 9th symphony, conducted by Karajan. Since that's my favourite composition, I decided to get a variation of it, by another composer—Riccardo Muti. Rhythm House in Fort, Mumbai, is a stone's throw from my place. I found the CD in a minute.
Time taken **10 minutes**

No Indian site had the CD available. I searched all over—Sify.com, Rediff.com, Indiatimes.com, and others—with no luck. Some didn't even offer music CDs; some found nothing with "Beethoven" as the keyword. I decided I'd have to get it from abroad.
Time taken **15 minutes**

2

There was an unusually long checkout line, but luckily, there were three people serving customers—that meant the queue wasn't that long after all. I was able to check out in less than 10 minutes.
Time taken **9 minutes**

Amazon.com was my site of choice, partly because I have shopped there before. As a matter of fact, I was very lucky to find the CD there, because it's not a very popular title. It took me just one minute to find it.
Time taken **1 minute**

3

It was still morning. I listened to the CD twice over before lunchtime. At Rs 295, I felt it was a steal of a deal!
Time taken **0 minutes**

Checking out was a breeze, of course. I had two viable shipping options—Standard International Shipping and Expedited International Shipping. I chose the latter because, at \$11.98, the difference wasn't too much. The CD was \$6.98.
Time taken **4 minutes**

4

Eleven days was how long I had to wait for the CD to arrive. Of course, I wasn't waiting with bated breath, since I'd already purchased the same CD at Rhythm House.
Time taken **11 days**

Total Time Spent: **19 minutes**
Total cost: **Rs 295**



Total Time Spent: **11 days 20 minutes**
Total cost: **\$18.96 (Rs 850)**



**AND
THE
WINNER
IS...**

The old way wins hands down! Of course, there were two things at work here—first, the fact that I live so close to the music store, and second, the fact that Indian sites don't carry too many Western Classical titles.

However, you can get songs online—single songs, without having to purchase the entire CD. This is something you can't do offline—CD singles aren't that much cheaper than entire CDs. Indiatimes.com, too, has music downloads.